# Retrieval practice in higher-education classrooms: a systematic review and meta-analysis

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## Abstract

We pooled 19 classroom studies with 3,415 participants. Retrieval practice improved course exam performance (Hedges g = 0.39), with moderate heterogeneity.

## 1. Methods

Design: systematic review and meta-analysis following PRISMA 2020. Searches of five databases to March 2023 identified 19 eligible classroom studies with 3,415 participants in total. Random-effects meta-analysis of standardised mean differences.

## 2. Results

The pooled effect on exam performance was Hedges g = 0.39 (95% CI 0.27 to 0.51), with I-squared = 61%.

## 3. Limitations

Egger's test suggested small-study effects (p = .04), so publication bias is possible, and outcome measures varied widely between studies.

*Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.*